Prof. Austin Zwick

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EDUCATION

PhD – Planning; University of Toronto (2018)

MPA – Nonprofit and Public Management; Cornell University (2012)

BSc – Industrial and Labor Relations; Cornell University (2009)

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Aug. 2018 – Present	Syracuse University, Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs / College of Professional Studies ○ Program Director of online BPS Policy Studies program (2022 – Present) ○ Associate Teaching Professor (2023 – Present) ○ Senior Research Associate, Autonomous Systems Policy Institute (2019 – 2023) ○ Shared Competencies Fellow, Information Literacy and Technological Agility (2022 - 2024) ○ Assistant Director, Policy Studies Undergraduate Program (2019 – 2023) ○ Assistant Teaching Professor (2018 - 2023)
Oct. 2024 – Present	Data & Policy Journal ○ Area Editor, Digital & Data-driven Transformations in Governance (2024 – Present)
Oct. 2022 – Nov. 2024	IET Smart Cities Journal ○ Associate Editor, City Design, Governance, Planning, and Policy (2022 – 2024)
Sept. 2012 – May 2018	University of Toronto, Department of Geography and Planning ○ Course Instructor (2017 – 2018) ○ Research & Teaching Graduate Assistant (2012 – 2017)
Sept. 2010 – May 2012	Cornell University, Office of Labor Education and Research ○ Lead Researcher (2011 – 2012) ○ Research Assistant (2010 – 2011)

BOOKS

Zwick, A. (Forthcoming). Built for No One: The Rise and Ruin of the E-topian Dream. *University of Toronto Press.*

Ness, I., Ovetz, R., Roque, I., Swidler, E., and **Zwick, A.** (2022). Routledge Handbook of the Gig Economy. *Routledge.*

Zwick, A. and Spicer, Z. (2021). The Platform Economy and the Smart City: Technology and the Transformation of Urban Policy. *McGill-Queen's University Press.*

COURSES TAUGHT

- Intro to Analysis of Public Policy
- Methods of Public Policy Analysis
- Methods in Political Science
- Advanced Policy Research
- Capstone in Public Affairs
- Community Benchmarking
- Global Leadership
- Issues in Creative Leadership
- Customer Relations Leadership
- Smart Cities and Urban Policy
- Cities & The Age of AI
- Data and Society

PUBLICATIONS

All published articles are available on my profile on ResearchGate

Zwick, A., Olmstead, N., and Spicer, Z. (2026). "Why Smart City Megaprojects Failed: Learning from the Past and Planning for the Future." *Cities.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cities.2026.107563

Zwick, A. (2026). "Something Wired This Way Comes: What Fracking Taught Planners That Data Center Communities Need to Learn." *Journal of the American Planning Association.* https://doi.org/10.1080/01944363.2026.2710901

Biggar, J., **Zwick, A.,** and Spicer, Z. (2026). "The Push to Promote the Smart City: Assessing the impacts of a government-led Smart City Challenge." *Local Economy.* https://doi.org/10.1177/02690942261477958

Zwick, A. and Spicer, Z. (2026). "The Inequities of Being Smart: Uneven Development and Smart City Technology Adoption." *Applied Geography.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.apgeog.2026.103976

Zwick, A. (2026). "From Pretextual Planning to Prezoning: The Case of Vancouver, British Columbia." *Urban Governance.* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ugj.2026.01.001

Zwick, A., Spicer, Z., and Bezdedeanu, C. (2025). "Do Small Towns Have Big Smart City Dreams?" *State & Local Government Review.* https://doi.org/10.1177/0160323X251343025

Spicer, Z. and **Zwick, A.** (2025). "Jurisdiction and Scale in Ridehailing: Options for Ontario." Technical Report for Uber Canada. https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=5237246

Zwick, A., Spicer, Z., Young, M., and Freeland, K. (2024). "Emerging Models of GHG Regulation in the Transportation-for-Hire Industry." *Sustainability 2024, 16(22), 10135;* https://doi.org/10.3390/su162210135

Zwick, A., Spicer, Z., and Eben, A. (2024). "Levelling Up Innovation in Local Government: An Evaluation of International Smart City Competitions." *Institute for Municipal Finance and Governance Papers. Issue No. 68.* https://utoronto.scholaris.ca/bitstreams/192147da-fda6-4c63-9f41-510f90132937/download

Zwick, A. Young, M., and Spicer, Z. (2024) "The Evolution of Ridehailing Regulation in Canadian Cities: COVID-19 and Policy Convergence." *In Brail, S. and Donald, B. Mobility Changes in the 21st Century City: How the iPhone, COVID, and Climate Changed Everything. University of Toronto Press.*

Zwick, A. and Spicer, Z. (2023). "Examining the Smart City Generational Model: Conceptualizations, Implementations, and Infrastructure Canada's Smart City Challenge." *Urban Affairs Review 60(4), 1229-1253.* https://doi.org/10.1177/10780874231222243

Zwick, A., Spicer, Z., and Young, M. (2022). **"**Moving Ideas? The News Media's Impact on Ridehailing Regulation in Canadian Cities." *Journal of Urban Affairs 46(2), 356–372.* https://doi.org/10.1080/07352166.2022.2053332

Zwick, A. (2022) "Entrepreneurial Finance Capital and the Gig Economy." Ness, I., Ovetz, R., Roque, I., Swidler, E., and **Zwick, A.** *Routledge Handbook of the Gig Economy. Routledge Press.*

Revington, N., **Zwick, A.**, Hartt, M., and Schlosser, J. (2021). **"**Universities and urban social structure: gentrification, studentification, and youthification in five United States legacy cities". *Urban Geography, 44:1, 83-104.* https://doi.org/10.1080/02723638.2021.1985306

Stewart, N., **Zwick, A.**, and Dundon, E. (2021). "From Processors to Platforms: Innovation and the Changing Nature of Space." *In **Zwick, A**. and Spicer, Z. The Platform Economy and the Smart City: Technology and the Transformation of Urban Policy**. McGill-Queen's University Press.***

Spicer, Z. and **Zwick, A.** (2021). "A Smart City for Toronto: What Does Quayside Tell Us about the State of Smart City Building?" *In **Zwick, A**. and Spicer, Z. The Platform Economy and the Smart City: Technology and the Transformation of Urban Policy. McGill-Queen's University Press.*

Hartt, M., **Zwick, A.** and Webb, B. (2021). "The Promise and The Peril of the Smart City." *In **Zwick, A**. and Spicer, Z. The Platform Economy and the Smart City: Technology and the Transformation of Urban Policy. McGill-Queen's University Press.*

Hartt, M., **Zwick, A.**, and Revington, N. (2020). "Resilient Shrinking Cities: Framing Our Understanding." *In Michael Burayidi, Adriana Allen, John Twigg, and Christine Wamsler. A Handbook on Regional Resilience. ISBN 9781138583597*

Goodman, N., **Zwick, A.,** Spicer, Z., and Carlsen, N. (2020). "Public Engagement in Smart City Development: Lessons from Communities in Canada's Smart City Challenge." *The Canadian Geographer / Le Géographe canadien, 64: 416-432.* https://doi.org/10.1111/cag.12607

Zwick, A. and Spicer, Z. (2019). "Remedy or Blight: Ridehailing's Role in the Precarious Economy." *Planning Theory & Practice, 20:3, 423-446.* https://doi.org/10.1080/14649357.2019.1629197

Spicer, Z., Eidelman, G., and **Zwick, A.** (2019). "Patterns of Local Policy Disruption: Municipal and State Regulatory Responses to Uber." *Review of Policy Research 36: 146-167.* https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.12325

Ross, T., Mah, J., Biggar, J., **Zwick, A**. & Modlinska, E. (2018). "Student Needs, Employment Realities, and PhD Program Design in Canada: The Case of Planning PhD Programs." *Canadian Journal of Higher Education / Revue canadienne d'enseignement supérieur, 48(3), 82–97.* https://doi.org/10.7202/1057130ar

Zwick, A. and Spicer, Z. (2018). **"**Good or Bad? Ridesharing's Impact on Canadian Cities." *The Canadian Geographer / Le Géographe canadien, 62: 430-436.* https://doi.org/10.1111/cag.12481

Zwick, A. (2018) "Fallow Appalachia." New Geographies 10. Harvard University Press.

Zwick, A. (2018) "Comparison of the Coal and Fracking Industries in Northern Appalachia." *Journal of Appalachian Studies. Volume 24 (2): 169 -184.* https://doi.org/10.5406/jappastud.24.2.0168

Zwick, A. (2018) "The Public Finance Challenges of Fracking for Municipal Governments in the United States." *Institute on Municipal Finance and Governance Paper No. 38.* https://imfg.org/uploads/469/thumb/paper_38_paper_thumbnail.pdf

Zwick, A., Revington, N., and Hartt, M. (2018). "Anchors & Diversity: Understanding Resilience in Canadian Midsize Cities." *Discussion Paper. Evergreen CityWorks: Midsize Cities Collaborative.*

Zwick, A. (2017). "Welcome to The Gig Economy: Neoliberalism's Industrial Relations and the Case of Uber." *GeoJournal 83, 679–691.* https://doi.org/10.1007/s10708-017-9793-8

Zwick, A. (2017). "Economic Specialization in Ontario's Midsize Cities: Clusters and Anchor Institutions." *Discussion Paper. Evergreen CityWorks: Midsize Cities Collaborative.*

Zwick, A. (2017). "Public Finance and City Typology: A Case-Study of Ontario's Midsize Cities." *Discussion Paper. Evergreen CityWorks: Midsize Cities Collaborative.*

Zwick, A. (2017). "Internet and the Sharing Economy." *In Warf, Barney. The Encyclopedia of the Internet. Sage Publications. Online ISBN:9781473960367.*

PAPERS IN PROGRESS

Zwick, A., Biggar, J., Spicer, Z. (*3rd submission*). "The State of Canadian Smart City Building: A Review of Literature and Practice." *Canadian Public Administration.*

Spicer, Z., Young, M., and **Zwick, A.** *(Under Review)* "Sidewalks and Systems: Politician Attitudes Toward Human and Robotic Delivery in Canadian Cities"**.** *Canadian Planning and Policy.*

Young, M., **Zwick, A**., Spicer, Z., Wolf, A., Aitken, I. *(Under Review)* "Working conditions and labour realities of platform delivery drivers: A critical systematic review of the literature." *Technology and Society.*

Zwick, A. *(Under Review).* "The Smart City at the Regime Frontier: Divergent Urban Technology Pathways in Democratic and Authoritarian Contexts." *Information Polity.*

Zwick, A. and Mevec, J. *(Under Review)* "Local government and AI: Emerging municipal approaches to policy, governance, and administration." *PlaNext.*

Spicer, Z., Young, M., and **Zwick, A.** *(Under Review).* "Who Should Regulate Emerging Technologies? Responsibility Attribution and the Governance Expectations Gap in Canadian Municipalities." *Publius.*

Zwick, A., Young, M., Spicer, Z., and Bouchebbah, L. *(Under Review)* "The Ungoverned Last Mile: Food Delivery, Infrastructure, and the Local Governance Gap"**.** *Urban Affairs Review.*

Zwick, A. (*Under Review*). "Racing Ahead of the Rules: The Deployment Gap in the AI-Driven Smart City and the Regulation It Necessitated in New York City." *Book Chapter in Rahmani-Andebili, M. AI-Based Smart Cities. Springer-Nature Press.*

Zwick, A. and Mevec, J. *(Under Review)* "Measuring Municipal AI Governance: A Comparative Framework and Findings from 30 North American Cities." *Government Information Quarterly.*

Zwick, A. and Lubin, J. (*In Progress*). "Whose Comments Count? Public Participation and New York City's AI Oversight Law." *Policy & Internet.*

Lubin, J. and **Zwick, A.** (*Abstract Accepted*). "What the Attentive Public Wants in AI Regulation: A Descriptive Map of Online Public Concerns." *AI for Future Societies: Policymaking, Equity, and Social Justice. Springer.*

Zwick, A. (*Abstract Accepted*). "Jammed Open: Why Municipal AI Oversight Goes Beyond the Procurement Gate." *Frontiers in Sustainable Cities. Special Issue on: Trajectories of AI urbanism and Smart Cities – Continuity, Acceleration, Transformation, Disruption?*

Zwick, A., Revington, N., and Hartt, M. (*In Progress*). Campus Commons: Closed Colleges to Open Social-Housing Villages. *TBD.*

INVITED TALKS

"Levelling Up Innovation in Local Government: An Evaluation of International Smart City Competitions." *Institute for Municipal Finance and Governance Papers. August 7, 2024.*

"Lunch and Learn: Emerging Technologies in Transportation." *Presenter. October 12, 2022. Ontario Ministry of Transportation.*

"Smart Cities: The Rise and Fall of Google's Sidewalk Toronto." Presenter. August 24, 2022. Huazhong University of Science and Technology.

"Book Launch: The Platform Economy and the Smart City: Technology and the Transformation of Urban Policy." *Presenter. October 28, 2021. York University.*

"Policy and Governance of Autonomous Systems." *Panelist. Syracuse University. May 6, 2019.*

"Differing Municipal Approaches to Canada's Smart City Challenge." *Panelist. York University. Nov. 07, 2018.*

"Economic Specialization in Ontario's Midsize Cities: Clusters and Anchor Institutions + Public Finance and City Typology: A Case-Study of Ontario's Midsize Cities." *Invited Talk. CityAge & Evergreen CityWorks Joint Conference, May 2017 – Hamilton, ON.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Presenter: "Fumbled Lateral After the Snap: Cities as the Offensive Line of AI Governance". *Urban Affairs Association. April 2027– New York, New York*

Presenter: "Code, Curbs and Couriers: Labour Resistance and Municipal Regulation of Food-Delivery Platforms." *Canadian Association of Geographers. June 2026– Victoria, British Columbia*

Presenter: "Local government and generative AI: Emerging municipal approaches to policy, governance, and administration." *Urban Affairs Association. April 2026– Chicago, Illinois*

Panelist: "Pretextual to Preapproved Planning: The Case of Vancouver, BC". *Urban Affairs Association. April 2025 – Vancouver, British Columbia*

Presenter: "The Cost of Being Smart: Innovation, Inequity and Smart City Technology Adoption." *American Association of Geographers. March 2025 – Detroit, Michigan*

Presenter: "Smart City Policy: Democracy, Authoritarianism, and Urban Technology." *Urban Affairs Association. April 2024 –New York, New York.*

Presenter: "Models of Emerging Regulation of GHG Emissions for Ridehailing." *International Public Policy Association. June 2023 – Toronto, ON.*

Presenter: "Exploring Future Cities and Priorities in a Post-Pandemic World." *Future Cities Roadshow, March 2023 – Vancouver, BC.*

Presenter: "Beyond the Challenge: Assessing the Impact of Infrastructure Canada's Smart City Challenge." *American Collegiate Schools of Planning, November 2022 – Toronto, ON.*

Moderator: "Academic – Industry –Government Blockchain Research Roundtable: Business & Policy Models." *Syracuse Blockchain and Cryptocurrency Research Workshop, August 2021 – Online*

Panelist: "Launching and Sustaining Undergraduate Programs in Professional Policy Schools." *National Association of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration, October 2020 – Online.*

Presenter: "The Smart, Just City." *American Association of Geographers, April 2019 – Washington, D.C.*

Organizer/Presenter: "The Platform Economy and the City." *Urban Affairs Association. Apr. 2018 – Toronto, ON.*

Presenter: "The Role of Innovation in Postindustrial Transformations." *Regional Studies Association, June 2017 – Dublin, Ireland*

Panelist: "Fiscal Health of Ontario Cities." *Canadian Association of Geographers, May 2017 – Toronto, ON.*

Organizer/Panelist: "A Roundtable Discussion on (Non-)Academic Employment, and Curricula Design." *Workshop co-organizer. American Collegiate Schools of Planning, Nov. 2016 – Portland, OR.*

Presenter: "Tacit Knowledge in an Era of Neoliberal Industrial Relations." *Regional Studies Association, May 2016 – Atlanta, GA*

Organizer/Panelist: "Midsize Cities: Challenges and Opportunities." *Canadian Association of Geographers, May 2016 – Toronto, ON.*

Presenter: "The Persistence of Impoverished Neighborhoods in Shrinking Cities." *American Association of Geographers, April 2015 – Chicago, IL*

PEER REVIEWS COMPLETED FOR:

- GeoJournal
- Journal of Urban Affairs
- Annals of the American Association of Geographers
- Local Environment
- Canadian Geographies
- Employment Relations
- Asia & Pacific Studies
- Employee Relations
- Canadian Planning and Policy
- Journal of Appalachian Studies
- Urban Studies
- Urban Planning
- Urban Affairs Review
- City and Environment Interactions
- Data & Society
- Journal of the American Planning Association

ADDITIONAL TRAINING AND CERTIFICATES:

- Teaching Public Service in the Digital Age (2025)
- Leading Smart Cities with Trust – Syracuse University (2023)
- Indigenous Canada – University of Alberta (2021)
- Intermediate R – DataCamp (2016)
- Public Performance Measurement – Rutgers University (2011)

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

- (Under Review). Racing With AI: A Learner Design Council for Non-Traditional Students. Humanity AI. MacArthur Foundation. (US$500,000)
- Co-PI under PIs LaVerne Gray and Beth Patin. From Highways to High-speed Internet: Leveraging Equitable Infrastructure for the Data Economy. Lender Center for Social Justice Grant. MetLife Foundation. ($110,518).
- Syracuse University's Maxwell School's Baldanza Advisor of the Year 2022-2023 ($500).
- Awards to Scholarly Publications Program, 2021 ($8,000).
- Lincoln Institute of Land Policy C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, 2017 (US$10,000).
- Institute on Municipal Finance and Governance (IMFG) Graduate Fellowship, 2016 (C$5,000).
- Centre for Study of the United States (CSUS) Scholarship, 2015 (C$1,500).